

Sundialling

Text by Annie Kierans
in conversation with Perennial
an exhibit by M.E. Sparks
at acaart,inc Nov 7 - Dec 19, 2025

"We require each other in unexpected collaborations and combinations, in hot compost piles." - Donna Haraway, *Staying With The Trouble*.

Within root and rot, energy is stowed to survive winter and wildfire. Densely woven mesh sprawls beneath blankets of snow and roving flame. Peonies can last a century this way, reincarnating from subterranean assemblages with no clear beginning or end.

One sphere gives way to another, cresting a plane. Sunbeams spill through cloud, smoke, dust, dew. Fog burns off. Kettle whistles. Flashes of form hopscotch into view. Uncertain geometries, wedges of luminosity. Hands bundle and chop. A pebble, a vase, a meadow, a galaxy. We spot a black hollyhock lacquered behind the corn stalks. Dark pools cut into spring greens. Wind rips at the seams. Rough-hewn peripheries. Endless changing fields.

A butterfly egg contains eyes, wings, antennae, and tiny feet that can taste nectar. As a caterpillar, it anchors itself to a branch with strands of silk, becoming a pupa. Its internal components reconfigure within the chrysalis in a state of suspension.

We unpin the laundry at dusk. The supermoon wanes. Beavers retreat along the edges of the Assiniboine. Is there time to lodge the bulbs into the ground before it stiffens? After so much preening and pruning, we recline on our armatures, lulled by the circadian pendulum.

Books stack on every surface, spines exposed. The thrum of pollinators sinks into loose bramble. Shaggy mounds of bog moss sigh. Stalagmite performs its glacial drip. Indiscernibly, we are carried along vast tectonic journeys, while discarded socks wilt at the end of our beds. Soft statues in blotted indigo - a crepuscular bouquet. Our insides muddle, just on the cusp of recognition.

Waxen wings unfold, tendrils unfurl. Traces of the past resurface. Same material, shapes fresh and new.

I find out "flesh" in English is « la chair » in French, from the Latin *cathedra*. The elements enter us; we wear the passage of time; we are receptive instruments. Pockmarked, hole punched. A multitude of windows, bringing outside in.

To write within four corners of a page may be countercurrent to work that defies the confines of a single frame. Infinite iterations are possible from improvised choreographies and elements in flux. Tossing, turning, tuning, shifting, revealing, concealing, searching, letting go. Rain check, red sky, palms to breeze. Trying this, that, there, or maybe here.

Haraway, Donna J. *Staying With the Trouble: Making Kin in the Chthulucene*. 2016. Duke University Press, Durham, 2016.

